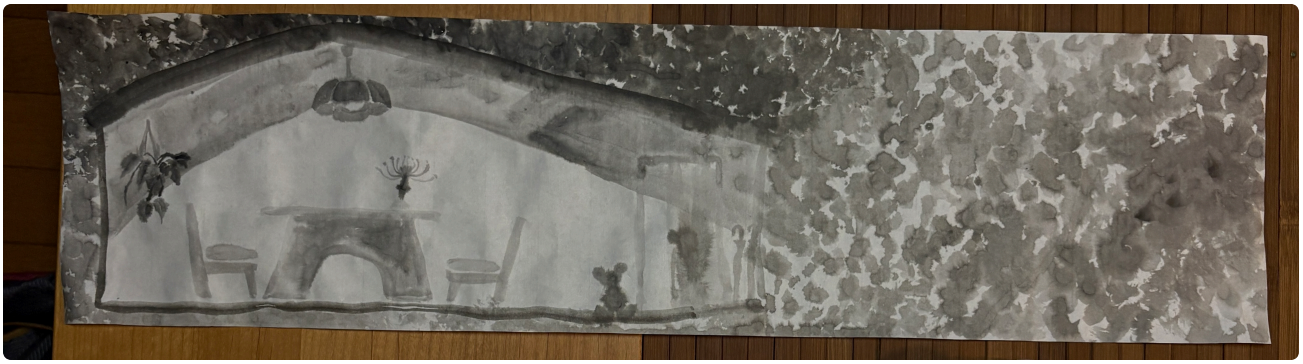


Title：Home, Body and Environment

This research will combine theoretical reading, artistic case studies, material experiments and practice-based reflection to investigate the subject through a written dissertation.

Research Background and Motivation

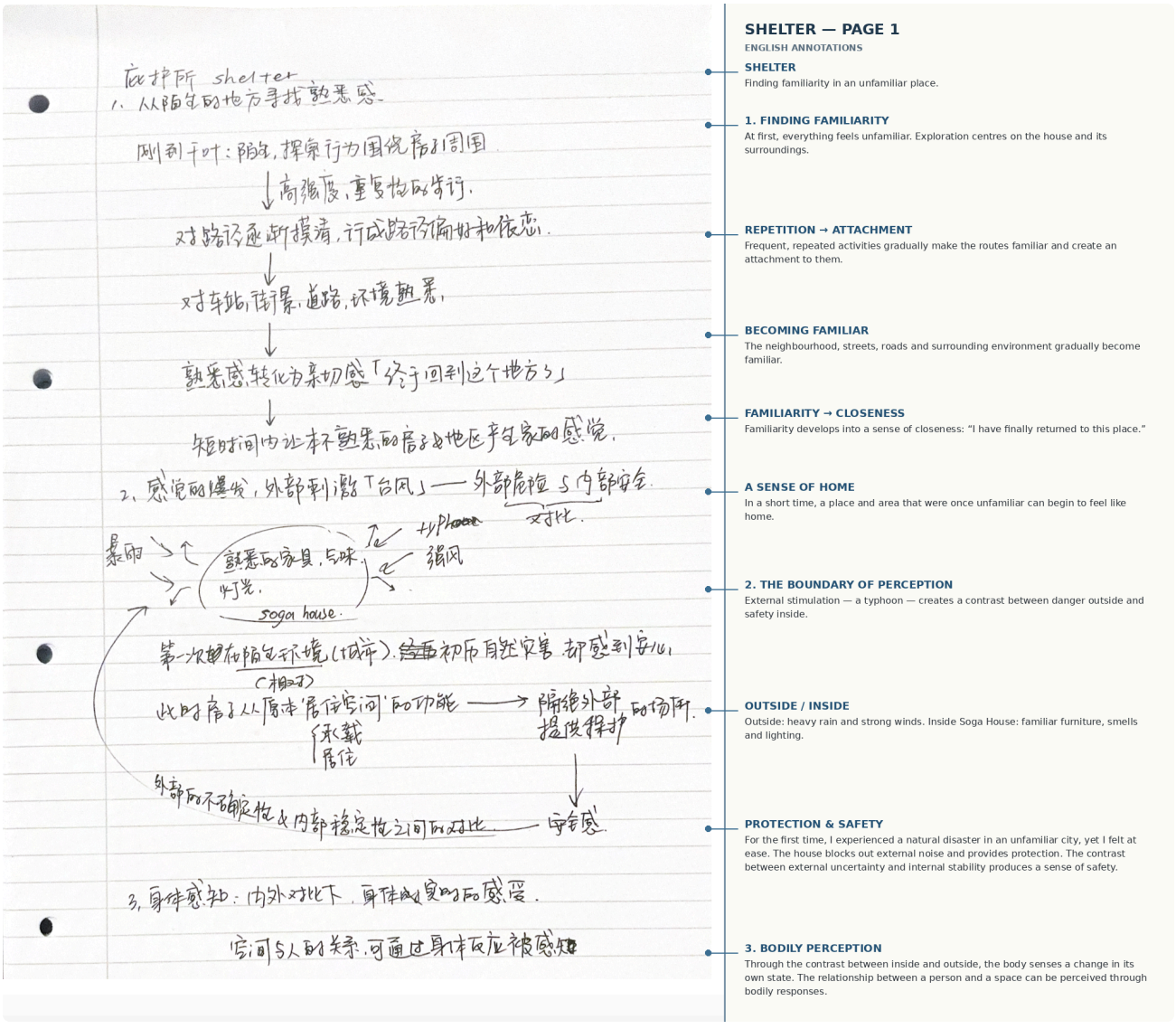
In my previous artistic practice, I have frequently explored questions related to bodily perception, such as how human perception takes place, how the body, environment, materials and technology interact with one another, and the relationships between humans and invisible phenomena.

Through my recent lived experiences, I have become increasingly aware that, in an increasingly mobile society, people are more frequently questioning their own sense of belonging. Artists also often take the perceptual relationships between home, body and environment as a starting point to explore security, vulnerability and the connections between people and the world around them. Therefore, I would like to begin this research with my own lived experiences, taking *Home* as a concrete point of departure. As someone living within a mobile society, home occupies a particularly significant place in my personal experience. When people talk about a sense of belonging, home is also often one of the first things that comes to mind. Starting from my own experiences, I hope to explore how we can rethink the relationships between home, body and environment through embodied experience and bodily perception, while identifying both shared experiences and differences.

This research will first examine the different dimensions of the concept of home. Firstly, home will be considered as a physical space (*Home as a Physical Space*), focusing on architecture, dwelling and their function of providing protection. Secondly, home will be understood as a product of emotional relationships (*Home as a Product of Emotional Relationships*), focusing on memory, belonging, security and connections between people. Finally, home will be further considered as a relational condition (*Home as a Relational Condition*), exploring how the body, environment and non-human entities participate in the formation of home.

On this basis, I will question traditional understandings of home, particularly the idea of home as a physical space that provides protection, as well as the conventional binary division between the human as the inhabiting subject and the environment as something external. I will further explore whether home can be understood as a relational condition formed through embodied experience, emotions and ongoing interactions between humans and their environments. I also aim to examine how embodied experience reshapes our understanding of home and our relationship with the environment.

This project stems from my personal experience. After a short-term stay in an unfamiliar city, I began to reflect on the meaning of home.



SHELTER — PAGE 1

ENGLISH ANNOTATIONS

SHELTER
Finding familiarity in an unfamiliar place.

1. FINDING FAMILIARITY
At first, everything feels unfamiliar. Exploration centres on the house and its surroundings.

REPETITION → ATTACHMENT
Frequent, repeated activities gradually make the routes familiar and create an attachment to them.

BECOMING FAMILIAR
The neighbourhood, streets, roads and surrounding environment gradually become familiar.

FAMILIARITY → CLOSENESS
Familiarity develops into a sense of closeness: “I have finally returned to this place.”

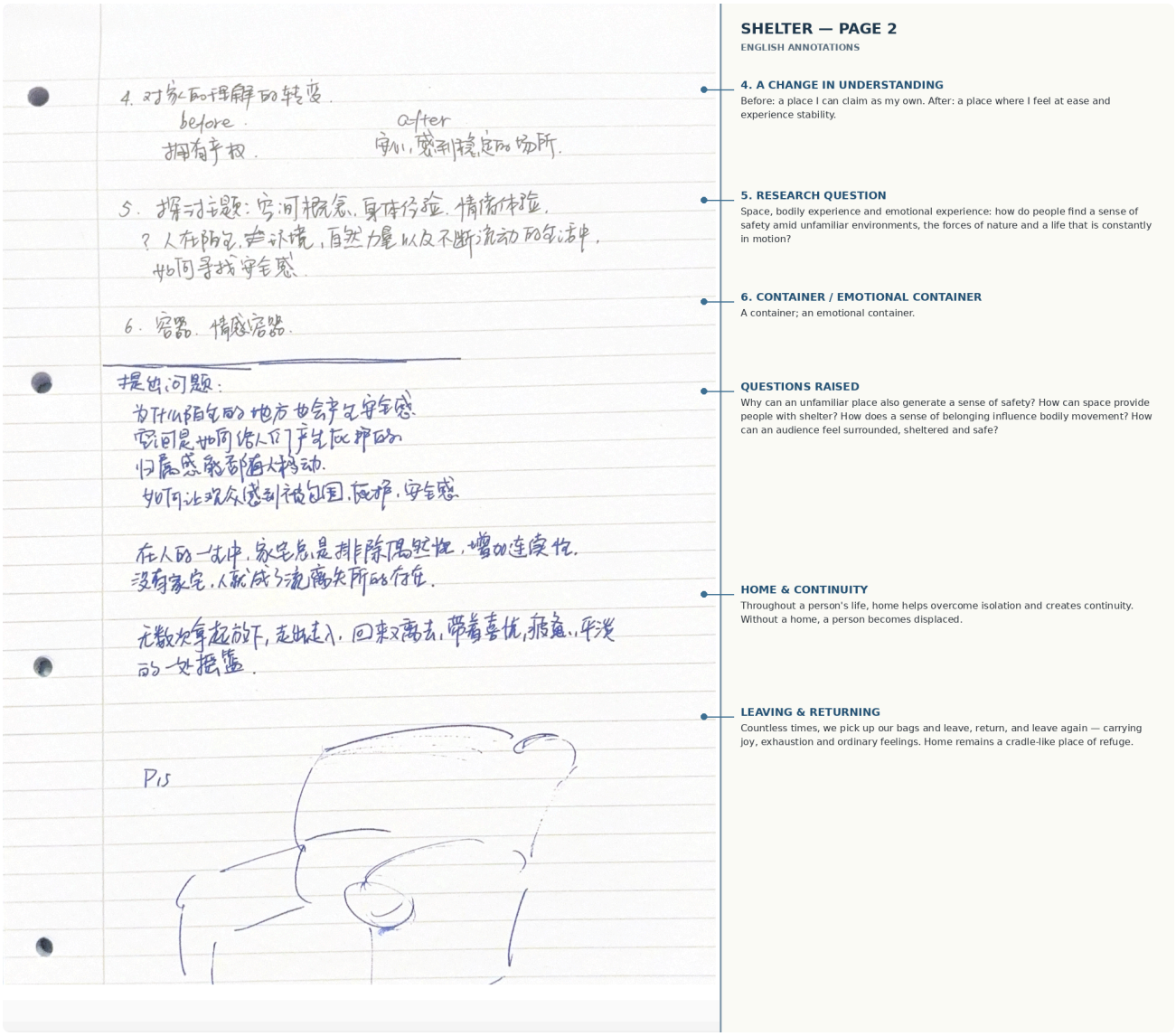
A SENSE OF HOME
In a short time, a place and area that were once unfamiliar can begin to feel like home.

2. THE BOUNDARY OF PERCEPTION
External stimulation — a typhoon — creates a contrast between danger outside and safety inside.

OUTSIDE / INSIDE
Outside: heavy rain and strong winds. Inside Soga House: familiar furniture, smells and lighting.

PROTECTION & SAFETY
For the first time, I experienced a natural disaster in an unfamiliar city, yet I felt at ease. The house blocks out external noise and provides protection. The contrast between external uncertainty and internal stability produces a sense of safety.

3. BODILY PERCEPTION
Through the contrast between inside and outside, the body senses a change in its own state. The relationship between a person and a space can be perceived through bodily responses.



Research Focus and Questions

Traditionally, home is often associated with a fixed living space, familiar surroundings, family relationships and a sense of security. However, experiences of environmental uncertainty, migration and vulnerability may challenge our existing understandings of these concepts. These are also some of the issues that have troubled me for a long time and contributed to my own sense of not belonging. In the context of migration, travel, cross-cultural living and an increasingly mobile society, the relationship between home and belonging has become more complex.

Through my own experiences and observations, I have found that a person can leave a place where they once lived while still maintaining an emotional attachment to it. Conversely, someone may live in a fixed location for a long time without ever developing a sense of belonging. It is also possible to develop a sense of familiarity or belonging towards an entirely new environment within a relatively short period of time. These different experiences have led me to question whether home necessarily depends on a fixed

physical space, and whether memory, embodied experience and relationships between people and their environments also participate in the formation of home.

Reference

This research will draw on phenomenological theory, particularly Maurice Merleau-Ponty's understanding of *Embodied Perception*, to explore how the body experiences and understands the world.

It will also refer to Gaston Bachelard's *The Poetics of Space*, which provides a theoretical perspective for understanding the emotional and imaginative dimensions of inhabited spaces and examining the nature of domestic space. In addition, this research will draw on other literature and references to further consider the relationships between human and non-human entities, the body and the environment, and subject and object. These theoretical perspectives will help me reflect on the traditional binary division between humans and their environments, and explore whether home, body and environment can be understood as entities that are formed through their mutual relationships.

With the support of these theoretical perspectives, I hope to extend the discussion of home, starting from my personal experiences of dwelling and perception, towards the relationships between humans and their environments, as well as the interdependence between human and non-human entities.